

The Cyrillic Projector

This is a sculpture in the University of North Carolina which was created by Jim Sanborn, an American artist, in the 1990s. It is an encrypted sculpture and is one of three puzzle sculptures made by Sanborn. The text on the sculpture is in Russian. It is essentially a riddle wrapped on a cylinder. One half of the cylinder is a 16th century decoding chart. The chart can be used to decode the other half of the cylinder, which contains a coded text describing the dangers of suppression of intellectual and artistic freedom.



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This was finally decrypted in 2003 by ElonkaDunin. The sculpture consists of two messages. One is Russian text that shows the usage of psychological control to develop and maintain sources of information. The second message pertains to the scientist Sakharov who was a Nobel Peace Prize winner as well as a Soviet dissident. The message finds its origins in classified KGB files.

The Oak Island treasure

Oak Island is a 140 acre privately owned island in Canada. It is noted as the location of the “Money Pit” and has been the site of a treasure hunt for over 200 years. Artifacts have reportedly been found as deep as 30 meters, but all such excavations ended in the collapse and flooding of the pit.

In 1975, after observing “strange lights”, a few teenagers discovered a depression on the south eastern end of the island. Upon digging up the depressed area, a layer of flagstones and markings from a pick were discovered. One of the larger stones had an inscription of symbols, and several attempts were made to decipher it. One of the most famous translations is “Forty feet below, two million pounds lie buried.” The pit subsequently flooded.

It has been argued that there is no treasure in the pit, and it is but a natural phenomenon. Such suggestions alleging the pit to be a natural sinkhole date back to early 1900s. There are numerous sinkholes on the mainland near the island, together with underground caves. Appearance of man-made pits has been attributed to the texture of sinkholes. The filling would be softer than surrounding ground leading to the impression that